WEEK 4 · LECTURE L1 OF 3 · UNIT II

HRIS: The System of Record

What an HRIS does, how to choose one, and the hidden cost of integration.

Part 1 HRIS, HRMS, HCM; one employee, one record

Part 2 Suite or best of breed; build, buy or configure

Part 3 Integration, and what four decades of e-HRM research show

Read Bondarouk, Parry and Furtmueller (2017); Caldwell (2022), HRIS chapter

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OPENING QUESTION

GreenLeaf runs two HRIS, one payroll system and a pile of spreadsheets. When the CFO asks how many people work here, which system answers?

PART A · THE HRIS LADDER

HRIS, HRMS and HCM are steps in scope

Term	What it covers	GreenLeaf today
HRIS	The core record: who works here, in what role, reporting to whom	SYS-01 LegacyHR, on premises
HRMS	The record plus transactions: payroll, leave, attendance	LegacyHR and PayEasy, run apart
HCM suite	Transactions plus talent: hiring, learning, performance, analytics	SYS-02 PeopleCloud, still a pilot

PART A · SYSTEM OF RECORD

One employee, one record

Definition

The system of record is the single authoritative source for each fact about an employee. Other systems read from it; none overwrites it.

0.43

LegacyHR adoption, 520 of 1,200 users

0.38

PeopleCloud pilot, 150 of 400 users

1.00

Spreadsheet Trackers adoption, with satisfaction of only 1.5 out of 5

PART A · THE ARCHITECTURE CHOICE

Suite or best of breed

Integrated suite

+ One vendor, one data model
+ Integration comes built in
– Weaker in some modules
– Harder to leave the vendor

Best of breed

+ Strongest tool for each module
+ Modules upgrade on their own
– Every pair of tools needs a connector
– Data definitions drift apart

Best of breed works only when one core HRIS holds the record and every other tool reads from it.

PART A · SOURCING THE SYSTEM

Build, buy or configure

Route	Fits when	Main risk	At GreenLeaf
Build	The process is a real advantage	Depends on a few people	SahayakBot, ESS App, ReferWin
Buy	The process is standard	Fit gaps, lock in, data residency	PeopleCloud, HireRight ATS
Configure	A bought platform needs local fit	Heavy customizing turns into a build	Most suite rollouts

PART A · THE HIDDEN COST

Integration does not appear on the invoice

120

possible point to point links among 16 systems, using n(n – 1) ÷ 2

6 of 10

HR processes run standalone, with no live data feed

1 of 10

process is fully integrated, and it is Payroll

Every unconnected system adds reconciliation, duplicate entry and a spreadsheet to bridge the gap.

L1 · THE RESEARCH

What four decades of e-HRM research says

Adoption has three drivers

Bondarouk, Parry and Furtmueller (2017) sort the evidence into technology, organization and people factors. All three must line up.

Efficiency is proven

The strongest evidence is for faster, cheaper, more accurate administration.

Strategy is not automatic

Evidence for strategic or relational gains is thinner, and depends on how the system is implemented and accepted.

THE LESSON

The same software produces different results in different firms. Implementation and user acceptance, not the license, decide the outcome.

Every tool bought before the record is settled becomes one more spreadsheet.